

Broadband in India = End of PC/Tech Mags in India?

**klinux
Digitized!**

Might not be in the immediate future as broadband speeds are... lousy. But, in the near future, when the tariff war is on and consumers get cheaper, faster and more efficient broadband services, would consumers/techies still want to buy PC/Tech mags, or rather download whatever he wants and get more articles from online mags?

What should Indian mags change, if they have to compete with broadband? Just curious!

**saROMan
In-House Geek**

Location: b4 my PIII
Depends... what r u buying the magz for... for the software in it... or for the contents... like Game/Hardware reviews... new emerging trends, etc.

ujjwal**Digitized Spammer**

Location: University .Area .Delhi
Yes, to a certain extent sales would be affected, as there are many people who buy the magazine for the CD and software. However, if the magazine kept Indian specific articles like current hardware prices, reviews of Indian ISPs, etc. people would still buy them.

**Nemesis
Digitized Spammer**

Location: New York
I agree with ujjwal... sales will b affected but not much... countries like the US have good broadband penetration... but still ppl read mags... but like ujjwal said, the mags here will have 2 carry a lot of Indian stuff like reviews, prices, availability, etc., of tech products in India and from an Indian perspective...

cheetah**Resident Techie**

Location: Jalandhar
I don't agree with that guy.

Nobody buys the mags for software only, we all buy because of new software they suggest, hardware reviews and cool site links.

For Example: I learnt about Skype from *Digit*. I learnt of the Slogger Firefox plug in from *Digit* Jan 2004, and it has changed my opinion about Firefox; now I use Firefox only and quit using Opera.

This is the use of these mags, they totally change the way u think.

**Indyan
Digitized!**

Location: Asansol, W.B.
As long as there r people like me who hate reading on their pc screens, mags wud remain alive. Also, I like da dvd.

A Taxing Regime

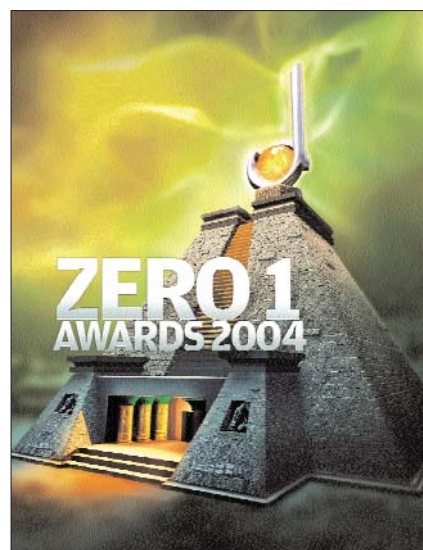
I was in south-east Asia recently, and was shocked to know the price difference between products available in India and there. I purchased a Sony digital camera (CyberShot P73), which costs Rs 18,990 in India, but Rs 12,500 in Singapore and Rs 10,000 in Malaysia. Sony even offered me a one-year international warranty for it.

Indians effectively pay Rs 9,000 in taxes for a product that costs Rs 10,000. I don't understand the reason for this. I also bought a Creative MuVO Slim 256 MB for Rs 6,000 which is available for Rs 8,000 in India. The good news is both the products I chose won the *Digit* 'Zero1 2004 Award' in the respective categories.

Saurabh Sahu,
Titilagarh (Orissa)

Hi Saurabh,
That's just like the icing on the cake. First you get these products at low prices, and then your choices win the *Digit* 'Zero1 Awards'. About the taxes: We wouldn't know whether the government is planning to bring down tariffs further on IT products this year, but prices of IT products have fallen drastically in the last three years, and will continue to fall this year. It is only a sign of a mature market that prices fall as demand rises. You don't have to look further than the cell phone market—both handsets and call charges in India were the most expensive in the world when the services began. Today, with almost five crore cellular subscribers, we have one of the lowest tariffs in the world.

—Executive Editor

**English Only, Please!**

I was simply blown away by *Digit*'s latest offer where you offered four DVD movies—*The Lord of the Rings*, *Terminator 2*, *Shakti*, and *Munna Bhai MBBS*—free with every subscription.

But guess what, I am disappointed! *Digit* is read all over India, and not every region appreciates Hindi movies. For them, the two Hindi DVDs are a plain waste. May I request *Digit* to respect the cultural and lingual diversity our country by giving only English movies so that every one benefits from the offer?

M S Karthikeyan
Chennai

Dear Karthikeyan,
At *Digit*, we believe creativity knows no language barriers. The movies we chose are some of the greatest Hollywood and Bollywood hits; each one of them is a masterpiece in its genre—whether fantasy or science fiction or drama or comedy. It will not be possible for us to change the movies as they were chosen after careful consideration. For now, you use the sub-titles feature on DVDs to enjoy the Hindi movies.

—Executive Editor

Who's Illiterate? Cops or Executive Editor?

So, it is this balmy Thursday morning, and I am walking around in the market when I see the January issue of *Digit*. I buy it first up, come home and read the editorial.

It was awesome! Mr Executive Editor Sir, you have said it all in just a few lines. It had just the right stuff I needed to explain to everyone in defence of Baazee.com CEO Avnish Bajaj. My friends and relatives just did not seem to understand when I told them earlier.

Delhi has seen it all—from teachers and parents giving us embarrassing speeches to innocent people being taken into custody to raiding cyber café's. The capital is going crazy and the reason? Technology illiteracy!

Who can even think of arresting Avnish Bajaj, the head of one of the few dotcom success stories in India? Only pot-bellied Delhi policemen!

About the so-called "tech-savvy" media, the less said the better. They don't even realise that the video that caused all this cannot even be sent through MMS, only via Bluetooth and Infrared cell phones. I have now come to